

Marilyn Horta, PhD

Tampa, FL, USA • mhorta09@gmail.com • MarilynHorta.com • [Google Scholar](https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=U3333333333333333)

Professional Summary

Applied Research Scientist with advanced training in health behavior change & social-cognitive/affective neuroscience, specializing in tobacco cessation/harm reduction, cancer-related risk behaviors, & health outcomes. Extensive experience designing & executing behavioral studies involving pharmacological & digital health interventions with strong data analytic expertise. Strong record of independently leading research projects, publishing peer-reviewed manuscripts, securing grant funding, & translating scientific findings into actionable knowledge for real-world application.

Education

- 2014 – 2020** University of Florida, Gainesville, FL, USA
Dual-Specialization PhD Program
Developmental Psychology and Behavioral/Cognitive Neuroscience
- PhD in Psychology
 - Gerontology Graduate Certificate
 - MS in Psychology
- PhD Dissertation:
- “Chronic intranasal oxytocin administration effects on dynamic emotion identification and related functional connectivity in healthy older adults” ([Read here](#))
- Master’s Thesis:
- “Effects of single-dose intranasal oxytocin administration on dynamic facial emotion identification among young and older adults” ([Read here](#))
- 2013 – 2014** Emory University, Atlanta, GA, USA
Post-Baccalaureate Research Education Program
(R25GM089615)
- 2009 – 2013** Florida State University, Tallahassee, FL, USA
Honors College and Dual-Degree Bachelor's Program
- BS in Psychology
 - BS in International Affairs

Positions

- 2024 -** Department of Health Outcomes and Behavior at Moffitt Cancer Center (R01CA255265, R01DA055298, R34CA297368)
Position: Applied Research Scientist 1
Supervisors: Christine Vinci, PhD and Vani Simmons, PhD
- 2022 - 2024** Department of Psychology at the University of Florida (3R01AG072658-01A1S1)
Position: Research Scientist
Supervisor: Natalie Ebner, PhD
- 2020 – 2022** National Institute on Drug Abuse Substance Abuse Training Center in Public Health T32 Program at the University of Florida (T32DA035167)
Position: Postdoctoral Fellow
Mentor: Roger Fillingim, PhD
Director: Linda Cottler, PhD
- Summer 2018** The Laboratory of Brain and Cognition at McGill University and the Montreal Neurological Institute

Position: Summer Research Trainee

Mentor: Nathan Spreng, PhD

2017 – 2019 National Institute on Aging T32 Fellowship on Physical, Cognitive, and Mental Health in Social Context at the University of Florida (T32AG020499)

Position: Predoctoral Fellow

Mentor: Natalie Ebner, PhD

Director: Michael Marsiske, PhD

Summer 2015 Multimodal Neuroimaging Training Program at Carnegie-Mellon University and the University of Pittsburgh (R90DA023420, T90DA022761)

Position: Summer Research Fellow

Mentors: Kirk Erickson, PhD, Fatma Uyar, PhD

Directors: Peter Gianaros, PhD, William Eddy, PhD

2014 – 2020 Social Cognitive and Affective Development Lab at the University of Florida

Position: Graduate Assistant

Mentor: Natalie Ebner, PhD

2013 – 2014 Post-Baccalaureate Research Education Program at Emory University (R25GM089615)

Position: Post-Baccalaureate Research Fellow

Mentors: James Rilling, PhD, Jennifer Mascaro, PhD

Directors: Gordon Churchward, PhD, Catherine Quinones, PhD, Charles Moran, PhD

Peer-Reviewed Publications

[Bibliography available here](#)

Martinez U, Vinci C, Hernandez P, **Horta M**, Blackwell R, Brandon TH, Simmons VN. Mobile App-Based Smoking Cessation in Hispanic or Latino Adults: Culturally Tailored Spanish-Language Formative App Development Study. JMIR Form Res. 2026 May 19;10:e84249. doi: 10.2196/84249. PMID: 42155124; PMCID: PMC13186525.

Iversen IA, Alaerts K, Bakermans-Kranenburg M, Becker B, Blair RJ, Bartz JA, Connelly JJ, Ditzen B, Ebner NC, Kang H, Lawson EA, Lønfeldt NN, Moerkerke M, Montag C, Mora-Jensen AC, **Horta M**, Peled-Avron L, Procyshyn TL, Sartorius AI, Scheele D, Schneider E, Theofanopoulou C, Yamasue H, Quintana DS. The active monitoring of oxytocin research evidence (AMORE) platform. Psychoneuroendocrinology. 2026 Mar;185:107713. doi: 10.1016/j.psyneuen.2025.107713. Epub 2025 Dec 5. PMID: 41389446.

Horta M, Augusto BM, Wright KL, Jacobsen P, Gonzalez B, Brandon TH, Vadaparampil ST, Simmons VN. 20 Years in the Making: Advancing Postdoctoral Training in Translational Behavioral Oncology. J Cancer Educ. 2025 Dec 6;10.1007/s13187-025-02800-1. doi: 10.1007/s13187-025-02800-1. Epub ahead of print. PMID: 41350962; PMCID: PMC12978137.

Horta M, Poudel R, Brandon KO, Dougan SO, Yates H, Rivera MS, Martinez U, Sutton SK, Vidrine DJ, Ritterband LM, Wiseman KP, Vickerman KA, Turner K, Byrne MM, Yang MJ, Anyanwu OA, Brandon TH, Vinci C. Glitches to growth: Lessons learned from developing and testing an augmented reality smartphone app for substance use treatment. Exp Clin Psychopharmacol. 2025 Dec 18;10.1037/pha0000815. doi: 10.1037/pha0000815. Epub ahead of print. PMID: 41411021; PMCID: PMC12716370.

Yepez V, Yang MJ, Washington S, Jones S, Poudel R, Pidala J, **Horta M**, Vinci C. AutoFOCUS: A mindfulness-based intervention for caregivers of autologous hematopoietic stem cell transplant recipients.

Palliat Support Care. 2025 Aug 22;23:e147. doi: 10.1017/S1478951525100485. PMID: 40842352; PMCID: PMC12491394.

Horta M, Wright K, Lighthall NR, Fillingim RB. Choosing well: A narrative review on chronic pain and decision-making. *J Pain*. 2025 Oct;35:105525. doi: 10.1016/j.jpain.2025.105525. Epub 2025 Aug 8. PMID: 40784540; PMCID: PMC12464965.

Poudel R, Dougan SO, Yates H, Sawyer L, Martinez U, Brandon KO, Sutton SK, Vidrine DJ, Ritterband LM, Wiseman KP, Vickerman KA, Turner K, Byrne MM, Yang MJ, **Horta M**, Brandon TH, Vinci C. Using augmented reality to deliver cue exposure treatment for smoking cessation: App usability findings and protocol for a randomized controlled trial. *Contemp Clin Trials*. 2025 Mar;150:107827. doi: 10.1016/j.cct.2025.107827. Epub 2025 Jan 27. PMID: 39880329; PMCID: PMC12149911.

Horta M, Shoenfelt A, Lighthall NR, Perez E, Frazier I, Heemskerk A, Lin T, Wilson RC, Ebner NC. Age-group differences in trust-related decision-making and learning. *Sci Rep*. 2024 Jan 2;14(1):68. doi: 10.1038/s41598-023-50500-x. PMID: 38167997; PMCID: PMC10762071.

Ebner NC, **Horta M**, El-Shafie D. New directions for studying the aging social-cognitive brain. *Curr Opin Psychol*. 2024 Apr;56:101768. doi: 10.1016/j.copsyc.2023.101768. Epub 2023 Nov 29. PMID: 38104362; PMCID: PMC10939782.

Horta M†, Polk R†, Ebner NC. Single dose intranasal oxytocin administration: Data from healthy younger and older adults. *Data Brief*. 2023 Oct 15;51:109669. doi: 10.1016/j.dib.2023.109669. PMID: 38020441; PMCID: PMC10630614. †Share equal authorship

Horta M†, Polk R†, Lin T, Perez E, Ojeda M, Porges EC, Nazarloo HP, Carter CS, Ebner NC. Evaluating the neuropeptide-social cognition link in ageing: the mediating role of basic cognitive skills. *Philos Trans R Soc Lond B Biol Sci*. 2022 Aug 29;377(1858):20210048. doi: 10.1098/rstb.2021.0048. Epub 2022 Jul 11. PMID: 35858076; PMCID: PMC9274329. †Share equal authorship

Rung JM, Kidder QA, **Horta M**, Berry MS, Ebner NC. Associations between alcohol use and peripheral, genetic, and epigenetic markers of oxytocin in a general sample of young and older adults. *Brain Behav*. 2022 Mar;12(3):e2425. doi: 10.1002/brb3.2425. Epub 2022 Feb 11. PMID: 35146961; PMCID: PMC8933764.

Horta M†, Lin T†, Heald K, Heemskerk A, Darboh B, Levi A, Spreng RN, Turner GR, Ebner NC. Loneliness progression among older adults during the early phase of the COVID-19 pandemic in the United States and Canada. *J Gerontol B Psychol Sci Soc Sci*. 2022 Apr 1;77(4):e23-e29. doi: 10.1093/geronb/gbab229. PMID: 34905015; PMCID: PMC8974322. †Share equal authorship

Valdés-Hernández PA, Polk R, **Horta M**, Frazier I, Perez E, Ojeda M, Porges EC, Cruz-Almeida Y, Feifel D, Ebner NC. Chronic oxytocin administration in older men modulates functional connectivity during animacy perception. *Aging Brain*. 2021 Oct 1;1:100023. doi: 10.1016/j.nbas.2021.100023. PMID: 36911518; PMCID: PMC9997159.

Rung JM, **Horta M**, Tammi EM, Perez E, Ojeda MC, Lin T, Harris G, Somerville J, Salmeron D, Beltz SE, Sandesara B, Feifel D, Ebner NC. Safety and tolerability of chronic intranasal oxytocin in older men: results from a randomized controlled trial. *Psychopharmacology (Berl)*. 2021 Sep;238(9):2405-2418. doi: 10.1007/s00213-021-05862-3. Epub 2021 May 12. PMID: 33982141; PMCID: PMC8115997.

Conner LB, **Horta M**, Ebner NC, Lighthall NR. Value network engagement and effects of memory-related processing during encoding and retrieval of value. *Brain Cogn*. 2021 Aug;152:105754. doi: 10.1016/j.bandc.2021.105754. Epub 2021 May 28. PMID: 34052683; PMCID: PMC8489736.

Horta M, Pehlivanoglu D, Ebner NC. The Role of Intranasal Oxytocin on Social Cognition: An Integrative Human Lifespan Approach. *Curr Behav Neurosci Rep*. 2020 Dec;7(4):175-192. doi: 10.1007/s40473-020-00214-5. Epub 2020 Sep 12. PMID: 33717829; PMCID: PMC7951958.

Horta M, Kaylor K, Feifel D, Ebner NC. Chronic oxytocin administration as a tool for investigation and treatment: A cross-disciplinary systematic review. *Neurosci Biobehav Rev*. 2020 Jan;108:1-23. doi: 10.1016/j.neubiorev.2019.10.012. Epub 2019 Oct 21. PMID: 31647964; PMCID: PMC6949379.

Horta M, Ziaei M, Lin T, Porges EC, Fischer H, Feifel D, Spreng RN, Ebner NC. Oxytocin alters patterns of brain activity and amygdalar connectivity by age during dynamic facial emotion identification. *Neurobiol Aging*. 2019 Jun;78:42-51. doi: 10.1016/j.neurobiolaging.2019.01.016. Epub 2019 Jan 29. PMID: 30870779; PMCID: PMC6545147.

Frazier I, Lighthall NR, **Horta M**, Perez E, Ebner NC. CISDA: Changes in Integration for Social Decisions in Aging. *Wiley Interdiscip Rev Cogn Sci*. 2019 May;10(3):e1490. doi: 10.1002/wcs.1490. Epub 2019 Jan 3. PMID: 30605250; PMCID: PMC8142223.

Gui WJ, Wang PY, Lei X, Lin T, **Horta M**, Liu XY, Yu J. Sleep facilitates consolidation of positive emotional memory in healthy older adults. *Memory*. 2019 Mar;27(3):387-396. doi: 10.1080/09658211.2018.1513038. Epub 2018 Aug 24. PMID: 30142023; PMCID: PMC8108548.

Li T, **Horta M**, Mascaro JS, Bijanki K, Arnal LH, Adams M, Barr RG, Rilling JK. Explaining individual variation in paternal brain responses to infant cries. *Physiol Behav*. 2018 Sep 1;193(Pt A):43-54. doi: 10.1016/j.physbeh.2017.12.033. Epub 2018 May 3. PMID: 29730041; PMCID: PMC6015531.

Ebner NC, Bailey PE, **Horta M**, Joiner JAE, Chang SWC (2017). Multidisciplinary perspective on prosociality in aging. In J Sommerville and J Decety (Eds.), *Social Cognition: Development Across the Life Span* (1st ed., pp. 303–325). Routledge. doi: 10.4324/9781315520575

Ebner NC, **Horta M**, Lin T, Feifel D, Fischer H, Cohen RA. Oxytocin modulates meta-mood as a function of age and sex. *Front Aging Neurosci*. 2015 Sep 10;7:175. doi: 10.3389/fnagi.2015.00175. PMID: 26441637; PMCID: PMC4565056.

Preprints

Horta M, Wright K, Lighthall NR, Fillingim RB. (2025, August 7). Choosing Well: A Narrative Review on Chronic Pain and Decision-making. https://doi.org/10.31219/osf.io/9c2hb_v2

Horta M, Shoenfelt A, Lighthall NR, Perez E, Frazier I, Heemskerk A, ... Ebner NC. (2023, April 21). Age-group Differences in Trust-related Decision-making and Learning. <https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/4hsu7>

Open Science Projects

Horta M†, Polk R†, Ebner NC. (2023). Single Dose Intranasal Oxytocin Administration: Data from Healthy Younger and Older Adults. *OpenNeuro*. [Dataset] doi:10.18112/openneuro.ds004725.v1.0.1. †Share equal authorship

Horta M, Shoenfelt A. (2023, February 15). Age differences in trust-related decision-making and learning. Retrieved from osf.io/cn8a2

Polk R, **Horta M**, Lin T, Porges E, Ojeda M, Nazarlo HP, ... Ebner NC. (2022, April 13). Evaluating the neuropeptide-social cognition link in aging: The mediating role of basic cognitive skills. <https://doi.org/10.17605/OSF.IO/XV38Y>

Rung JM, **Horta M**, Ebner NC. (2022, February 28). Safety and Tolerability of Chronic OT in Older Men: Data and Analyses. <https://doi.org/10.17605/OSF.IO/PNX9U>

Lin T, **Horta M**, Ebner NC, Turner GR, Spreng RN, Heald K, ... Darboh BS. (2021, March 17). Loneliness Progression Among Older Adults During the COVID-19 Pandemic in the United States and Canada. Retrieved from osf.io/2vdsh

Grants

2022 - 2024	PA-21-071 Research Supplement to Promote Diversity in Health-Related Research (3R01AG072658-01A1S1, PI: Ebner)	\$328,639
	Project Title: Characterizing and modulating neurocognitive processes of learning to trust and distrust in aging	
2021 - 2024	The University of Florida Center for Advancing Minority Pain and Aging Science Pilot Grant (P30AG059297, PI: Fillingim)	\$25,000
	Project Title: Understanding the impact of chronic pain on decision-making in aging	

Honors and Awards

Extramural		
2024	Florida Consortium on the Neurobiology of Cognition Best Question Award	\$200
2023	Scientific Research Network on Decision Neuroscience and Aging Open Data Award	\$1000
2023	US Association for the Study of Pain Travel Award	\$450
2023	National Institute on Drug Abuse Diversity Scholars Network	N/A
2021	Enhanced Interdisciplinary Research Training Institute on Hispanic Substance Abuse Fellowship	\$2000
2020	Institute for Learning and Retirement at Oak Hammock Robert Levitt Graduate Student Award for Aging Research	\$250
2019	Kavli Summer Institute in Cognitive Neuroscience Fellowship	~\$2000
2019	Institute for Learning and Retirement at Oak Hammock, Leighton E. Cluff Graduate Student Award for Aging Research	\$1200
2018	Scientific Research Network on Decision Neuroscience and Aging Mentorship/Collaboration Award	\$5000
2015 and 2020	Scientific Research Network on Decision Neuroscience and Aging Conference Travel Awards (2 awards total)	~\$4000
2014	Honorable Mention, Ford Foundation Fellowship Program	N/A
Intramural (University of Florida)		
2022	McKnight Brain Institute Training Enhancement Opportunity Award	\$2877
2020	Schumacher Award for Outstanding Dissertation in Psychology	\$2000
2019 – 2020	Jacquelin Goldman Dissertation Award	\$23,000
2019	College of Liberal Arts and Sciences Dissertation Fellowship	\$7000
2018	College of Liberal Arts and Sciences Conference Travel Award	\$300
2018	McKnight Brain Institute Travel Award	\$500
2016 – 2017	Jacquelin Goldman Single Year Awards (2 awards total)	\$12,000

2015 – 2019	Graduate Student Council Travel Awards (5 awards total)	\$1750
2015 – 2018	Office of Research Travel Awards (3 awards total)	\$1200
2015	Jacquelin Goldman Research Award	\$2000
2014 – 2019	Jacquelin Goldman Fellowship in Developmental Psychology	\$25,000
2014 – 2019	Graduate School Diversity Enhancement Award	\$20,000
2014 – 2018	Department of Psychology Conference Travel Awards (5 awards total)	\$2600
2014	Board of Education Summer Fellowship	\$1600

Presentations

* Indicates supervised undergraduate/post-baccalaureate student

Chaired Symposia

Horta M [chair], Businelle M [speaker], Kendzor D [speaker], Brandon T [speaker], Simmons V [speaker], Hébert E [speaker], Wetter D [discussant]. Innovative and Highly Scalable mHealth Interventions for Smoking Cessation. Society of Behavioral Medicine 47th Annual Meeting and Scientific Sessions, Chicago, IL, April 2026.

Horta M [chair], Alaerts K [speaker], Pehlivanoglu D [speaker], Sunahara C [speaker], Meisner O [speaker]. Oxytocin in social contexts: recent insights from neuroscience and behavior. Society for Social Neuroscience Virtual Meeting, November 2023.

Horta M [chair], Pehlivanoglu D [co-chair, speaker], Charness N [speaker], Pehlivanoglu D [speaker], Lighthall NR [speaker], Lin T [speaker]. Neurophysiological and behavioral determinants of deception risk in aging. Florida Consortium on the Neurobiology of Cognition Annual Meeting, Jupiter, FL, May 2023.

Oral Presentations and Invited Talks

Simmons V, Hernandez P, **Horta M**, Martinez U, Vinci C, Vidrine J, Martinez D, Brandon T. Libre del cigarrillo: A culturally adapted smoking cessation app for Spanish-speakers. Society of Behavioral Medicine 47th Annual Meeting and Scientific Sessions, Chicago, IL, April 2026.

Brandon T, Sutton S, Dougan SO, Yates H, **Horta M**, Brandon KO, Vinci C. Using augmented reality to deliver cue exposure treatment for smoking cessation. Society of Behavioral Medicine 47th Annual Meeting and Scientific Sessions, Chicago, IL, April 2026.

Yang M, Sutton SK, Poudel R, **Horta M**, Brandon K, Brandon TH, Vinci C. Mindfulness-Based Relapse Prevention and Cognitive Behavioral Therapy for Smoking Cessation and Alcohol Use: Exploratory Analysis of Change Mechanisms. Annual Meeting of Society for Research on Nicotine and Tobacco, New Orleans, LA, March 2025.

Horta M. Social cognition in aging: Linking the brain, behavior, and health. Tobacco Research and Intervention Program Meeting, Tampa, FL, November 2024.

Horta M. Chronic pain, substance use, and decision-making in adulthood and aging. Resource Centers for Minority Aging Research Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA, March 2023.

Horta M. Age differences in trust-related decision-making. North Central Florida Society for Neuroscience Annual Chapter Conference, Gainesville, FL, February 2023.

Horta M. Age differences in trust-related decision-making. Dallas Aging and Cognition Conference. University of Texas at Dallas, Dallas, TX, February 2023.

Horta M. Chronic pain and decision-making in adulthood and aging. University of Central Florida, Orlando, FL, October 2022.

Horta, M. Career Development Progress. Enhanced Interdisciplinary Research Training Institute on Hispanic Substance Abuse Annual Mentoring Meeting, Grand Rapids, MI, September 2022.

Horta M. Characterizing pain and co-occurring substance use across the adult lifespan in a community sample. Accounting for Older Adults in Substance Use Research, Treatment, and Policy Symposium at the College on Problems of Drug Dependence Annual Scientific Meeting, June 2022.

Horta, M. Oxytocin effects on functional connectivity relating to emotion identification in aging. Oxytocin and Vasopressin Workshop at the Ettore Majorana Foundation and Centre for Scientific Culture, Erice, IT, May 2022.

Horta M. Characterizing pain and co-occurring substance use across the adult lifespan in a community sample. Emerging Addiction Science Seminar Series at the Center of Alcohol and Substance Use Studies at Rutgers University, Piscataway, NJ, April 2022.

Horta M. Brain-behavioral approaches to social cognition in aging. University of Miami, Miami, FL, April 2022.

Horta M. Career Development Progress. Enhanced Interdisciplinary Research Training Institute on Hispanic Substance Abuse Annual Mentoring Meeting, Chicago, IL, November 2021.

Horta M. Brain-behavioral approaches to social cognition in aging. University of Texas at Dallas, Dallas, TX, October 2021.

Horta M. Biopsychosocial factors underlying chronic pain and pain self-management in Hispanic and non-Hispanic adults: Final research prospectus. Enhanced Interdisciplinary Research Training Institute on Hispanic Substance Abuse Summer Meeting, Pasadena, CA, June 2021.

Horta M, Lin T, Polk R, Feifel D, Ebner NC. Chronic intranasal oxytocin administration effects on dynamic emotion identification and related functional connectivity in healthy older adults. North Central Florida Society for Neuroscience 11th Annual (Virtual) Chapter Conference, Gainesville, FL, February 2021.

Horta M, Lin T, Peeling S*, Heemskerk A*, Spreng RN, Turner GR, Ebner NC. Loneliness and substance use during the COVID-19 pandemic among older adults in the US and Canada. University of Florida College of Public Health and Health Professions Virtual Research Day, Gainesville, FL, February 2021.

Horta M, Lin T, Polk R, Feifel D, Ebner NC. Effects of chronic intranasal oxytocin administration on dynamic emotion identification in older adults. 10th Annual Institute for Learning in Retirement Student Research on Aging Poster Competition and the Robert Levitt Awards at Oak Hammock, Gainesville, FL. February 2020.

Horta M, Ziaei M, Lin T, Porges EC, Fischer H, Feifel D, Spreng RN, Ebner NC. Oxytocin alters patterns of brain activity and amygdalar connectivity by age during dynamic facial emotion identification. North Central Florida Society for Neuroscience Conference, Gainesville, FL, January 2020.

Valdes-Hernandez PA, **Horta M,** Frazier I, Porges EC, Polk R, Perez E*, Ojeda M*, Cruz-Almeida Y, Morris JP, Feifel D, Ebner NC. Chronic oxytocin administration in older men modulates functional connectivity of the posterior superior temporal sulcus during social perception. Society for Neuroscience, Chicago, IL, October 2019.

Ebner NC, Månsson KNT, Lin T, Lussier D, **Horta M**, Frazier I, Weir D*, Feifel D, Fischer H. Neuroplasticity and cognitive benefits associated with chronic intranasal oxytocin administration in aging. Alpine Brain Imaging Meeting, Champéry, Switzerland, January 2019.

Poster Presentations

Vinci C, Sutton SK, **Horta M**, Poudel R, Yang MJ, Reblin M, Pidala J, Jim H, Washington S, Smith H. Using the NCCN distress thermometer to evaluate clinically elevated levels of distress among caregivers of HSCT patients. American Society of Clinical Oncology, Chicago, IL, May 2026.

Hernandez P, **Horta M**, Dougan S, Miller S, Rivera MS, Rivera A, Simmons VN, Vinci C. A qualitative study to inform the modification of an augmented reality-based cue-exposure app for vaping cessation among emerging adults. Moffitt Scientific Symposium, Tampa, FL, May 2026.

Kirtane K, Washington S, Smith H, Dougan S, **Horta M**, Poudel R, Vinci C. Development of a supportive care intervention for caregivers of head and neck cancer patients: a qualitative needs assessment. American Society of Clinical Oncology Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL, May 2026. **Online Publication.**

Horta M, Washington S, Smith H, Dougan SO, Poudel R, Arch J, Kirtane K, Vinci C. Worst-case scenarios, triggers, and coping strategies among head and neck cancer caregivers. American Society of Clinical Oncology Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL, May 2026. **Online Publication.**

Bethune B*, **Horta M**, Smith H, Washington S, Green BL, Vinci C. Associations between mindfulness, psychological distress, and coping among hematopoietic stem cell transplant caregivers. American Society of Clinical Oncology Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL, May 2026. **Online Publication.**

Poudel R, Dougan SO, Maconi ML, Rivera MS, Smith H, Washington S, **Horta M**, Witkiewitz K, Simmons VN, Vinci C. Adjusting to the new normal: Tailoring mindfulness-based relapse prevention for smoking and alcohol in cancer survivors. Society of Behavioral Medicine Conference, Chicago, IL, April 2026.

Poudel R, Rivera MS, Haver MK, **Horta M**, Dougan SO, Yates H, Brandon KO, Brandon TH, Vinci C. Augmented reality for the prevention and treatment of substance use disorders: A scoping review. Society of Behavioral Medicine Conference, Chicago, IL, April 2026.

Smith H, **Horta M**, Yates HC, Dougan SO, Rivera MS, Rivera A, Brandon KO, Martinez U, Sutton SK, Vidrine DJ, Ritterband LM, Wiseman KP, Turner K, Vickerman KA, Poudel R, Brandon TH, Vinci C. Understanding Low Engagement with an Augmented Reality Smartphone App for Smoking Cessation. Annual Meeting of Society for Research on Nicotine and Tobacco, Baltimore, MD.

Almendares M, Hernandez P, **Horta M**, Poudel R, Cwynar L, Martinez U, Vinci C, Vidrine J, Martinez-Tyson D, Brandon T, Meade C, Simmons V. From print to digital: Converting a culturally tailored printed smoking cessation intervention for Spanish-speakers into a smartphone app. 2025 Cancer Health Disparities Retreat at Moffitt Cancer Center, Tampa, FL, December 2025.

Bethune B*, **Horta M**, Otu J, Cottrell-Daniels C, Luck C, Lezama-Francois C, Vinci C, Green BL. Extending the reach: A narrative review on mindfulness-based interventions for African American caregivers and future applications in behavioral oncology. 2025 Cancer Health Disparities Retreat at Moffitt Cancer Center, Tampa, FL, December 2025.

Rivera MS*, **Horta M**, Smith HS*, Dougan SO, Yates HC, Poudel R, Brandon KO, Sutton SK, Vidrine DJ, Brandon TH, Vinci C. Advancing tobacco cessation in mHealth with technology-driven interventions: A scoping review. Moffitt Scientific Symposium, Tampa, FL, May 2025. **Voted "Best Poster" for Population Science.**

Smith HS*, **Horta M**, Dougan SO, Washington SJ, Yates HC, Pidala J, Reblin M, Jim H, Sutton SK, Vinci C. Examining COVID-related distress among allogeneic hematopoietic stem cell transplant caregivers. Moffitt Scientific Symposium, Tampa, FL, May 2025.

Cwynar L*, **Horta M**, Hernandez P, Simmons V. Culturally tailored mHealth interventions for Hispanic smokers: A scoping literature review and upcoming study protocol. OneUSF Undergraduate Research Conference, Tampa, FL, April 2025.

Romero Salgado J*, Smith HS*, **Horta M**, Vinci C. Examining the Role of Annual Income and Race/Ethnicity on Mental Health Symptom Severity among Hematopoietic Stem Cell Transplant Caregivers. OneUSF Undergraduate Research Conference, Tampa, FL, April 2025.

Smith HS*, **Horta M**, Dougan SO, Washington SJ, Yates HC, Pidala J, Reblin M, Jim H, Sutton SK, Vinci C. Linking COVID-related distress and mental health service utilization among allogeneic hematopoietic stem cell transplant patients. National Comprehensive Cancer Network Annual Meeting, Orlando, FL, March 2025.

Poudel R, Amish F, Washington S, Smith HS*, Dougan SO, Yang MJ, **Horta M**, Khimani F, Vinci C. Evaluating the Effect of a Mindfulness-Based Intervention on Metabolic and Immunological Biomarkers of Stress Among Caregivers of Allogeneic Hematopoietic Stem Cell Transplant Recipients: Trial in Progress. National Comprehensive Cancer Network Annual Meeting, Orlando, FL, March 2025.

Dougan SO, Yates HC, **Horta M**, Brandon KO, Rivera MS*, Smith HS*, Martinez U, Sutton SK, Vidrine DJ, Ritterband LM, Vickerman KA, Wiseman KP, Poudel R, Yang M, Brandon T, Vinci C. Utilizing Augmented Reality as an Adjunct for Smoking Cessation: Trial in Progress. National Comprehensive Cancer Network Annual Meeting, Orlando, FL, March 2025.

Horta M, Dougan S, Yates H, Brandon KO, Martinez U, Sutton SK, Vidrine DJ, Ritterband LM, Wiseman KP, Vickerman KA, Poudel R, Yang M, Smith H, Brandon T, Vinci C. The Limits of Capitalizing on New Technology: Evaluating Accessibility of an Augmented Reality Intervention for Smoking Cessation. Annual Meeting of Society for Research on Nicotine and Tobacco, New Orleans, LA, March 2025.

Horta M, Dougan S, Yates H, Brandon KO, Martinez U, Sutton SK, Vidrine DJ, Ritterband LM, Wiseman KP, Vickerman KA, Poudel R, Yang M, Smith H, Brandon T, Vinci C. The Limits of Capitalizing on New Technology: Evaluating Accessibility of an Augmented Reality Intervention for Smoking Cessation. 2024 Cancer Health Disparities Retreat at Moffitt Cancer Center, Tampa, FL, December 2024.

Lyons P*, El-Shafie D*, **Horta M**, Lin T, Ebner NC. Loneliness moderated effects of chronic pain on analytical reasoning. Fall Undergraduate Research Symposium at the University of Florida, Gainesville, FL, November 2024.

Alaerts K, Prinsen J, Ebner NC, **Horta M**, Zhao W, Kendrick KM. Announcement of the Oxytocin Brain Imaging Data Exchange Initiative. Organization for Human Brain Mapping, Seoul, KR, June 2024.

Horta M, Polk R, Ebner NC. Introducing an open dataset to examine single-dose intranasal oxytocin effects in healthy younger and older adults. Florida Consortium on the Neurobiology of Cognition, Miami, FL, May 2024.

Lyons P*, El-Shafie D*, **Horta M**, Lin T, Ebner NC. Loneliness-Moderated Effects of Chronic Pain on Analytical Reasoning. University of Florida Pain Research Day, Gainesville, FL, April 2024.

Lyons P*, El-Shafie D*, **Horta M**, Lin T, Ebner NC. Loneliness-Moderated Effects of Chronic Pain on Analytical Reasoning. University of Florida Spring Undergraduate Research Symposium, Gainesville, FL, April 2024.

Horta M, Shoenfelt A, Perez E, Lighthall NR, Ebner NC. Learning to trust: The role of uncertainty and experience for younger and older adults. Social and Affective Neuroscience Society, Toronto, ON, April 2024.

Polk R, El-Shafie D*, **Horta M**, Perez E, Heemskerk A*, Lin T, Feifel D, Ebner NC. Chronic intranasal oxytocin administration increases positive mood in older adults. Social and Affective Neuroscience Society, Toronto, ON, April 2024.

Horta M, Polk R, Ebner NC. Introducing an open dataset to examine single-dose intranasal oxytocin effects in healthy younger and older adults. Society for Social Neuroscience, Tsukuba, JP, March 2024.

Horta M, Shoenfelt A, Lighthall NR, Perez E, Frazier I, Heemskerk A*, Lin T, Wilson RC, Ebner NC. Facing Trustworthiness: Age-group differences in trust-related decision-making and learning. Gerontological Society of America, Tampa, FL, November 2023.

Horta M, Shoenfelt A, Lighthall NR, Perez E, Frazier I, Heemskerk A*, Lin T, Wilson RC, Ebner NC. Facing Trustworthiness: Age-group differences in trust-related decision-making and learning. Scientific Research Network on Decision Neuroscience and Aging, Santa Barbara, CA, May 2023.

Horta M, Chaudhari PV, Cottler L, Fillingim R, Striley C. Characterizing chronic pain and co-occurring substance use across the adult lifespan in a community sample. US Association for the Study of Pain Annual Meeting, Durham, NC, April 2023.

Horta M, Chaudhari PV, Cottler L, Fillingim R, Striley C. Characterizing chronic pain and co-occurring substance use across the adult lifespan in a community sample. National Hispanic Science Network, Grand Rapids, MI, September 2022.

Polk R†, **Horta M**†, Lin T, Porges E, Ojeda M, Nazarloo HP, Carter CS, Ebner NC. Evaluating the neuropeptide-social cognition link in aging: The mediating role of basic cognitive skills. Oxytocin and Vasopressin Workshop at the Ettore Majorana Foundation and Centre for Scientific Culture, Erice, IT, May 2022. †**Share equal authorship**

Wright K, **Horta M**, Rung J, Polk R, Heemskerk A*, Feifel D, Ebner NC. Safety and tolerability of chronic oxytocin administration and the modulatory role on affiliative processes in aging. North Central Florida Chapter of Society for Neuroscience Annual Meeting, Gainesville, FL, January 2022.

Polk R†, **Horta M**†, Lin T, Porges E, Ojeda M*, Nazarloo HP, Carter CS, Ebner NC. Evaluating the neuropeptide-social cognition link in aging: The mediating role of basic cognitive skills. North Central Florida Chapter of Society for Neuroscience Annual Meeting, Gainesville, FL, January 2022. †**Share equal authorship**

Horta M, Lin T, Heald K, Heemskerk A*, Peeling S*, Darboh B, Levi A, Spreng RN, Turner GR, Ebner NC. Loneliness, social support, and substance use among older adults in Canada and the United States before and during the COVID-19 pandemic. National Hispanic Science Network Annual Virtual Conference, September 2021.

Horta M, Lin T, Heald K, Heemskerk A*, Peeling S*, Darboh B, Levi A, Spreng RN, Turner GR, Ebner NC. Loneliness, social support, and substance use among older adults in Canada and the United States before and during the COVID-19 pandemic. College on Problems of Drug Dependence Annual Scientific Virtual Meeting, June 2021.

Rung JM, Tammi E, **Horta M**, Feifel D, Berry MS, Ebner NC. Safety and tolerability of intranasal oxytocin in older women. College on Problems of Drug Dependence Annual Scientific Virtual Meeting, June 2021.

Myers E*, Lussier D, **Horta M**, Frazier I, Polk R, Feifel D, Ebner NC. Increase in empathy and insula volume after 4-week intranasal oxytocin administration in older adults. North Central Florida Chapter of the Society for Neuroscience Annual Conference, Gainesville, FL, January 2019.

Lussier D, **Horta M**, Porges EC, Woods A, Cohen RA, Ebner NC, Cruz-Almeida Y. Pain modulation is associated with cingulate morphology in older adults with musculoskeletal pain. Society for Neuroscience, San Diego, CA, November 2018.

Horta M, Ziaei M, Lin T, Porges EC, Fischer H, Feifel D, Spreng RN, Ebner NC. Intranasal oxytocin modulates amygdalar connectivity by age during dynamic facial emotion identification. Society for Neuroscience, San Diego, CA, November 2018.

Horta M, Ziaei M, Lin T, Porges EC, Fischer H, Feifel D, Spreng RN, Ebner NC. Intranasal oxytocin modulates amygdalar connectivity by age during dynamic facial emotion identification. Resting-State and Brain Connectivity Conference, Montreal, QC, CA, September 2018.

Lussier D, Hayes R*, **Horta M**, Lin T, Frazier I, Weir D*, Perez E, Feifel D, Månsson KNT, Fischer H, Ebner NC. Four-week intranasal oxytocin vs. placebo administration modulation of amygdala and accumbens volume. Organization for Human Brain Mapping, Suntec, SG, June 2018.

Månsson KNT, Cortes DS, Lin T, **Horta M**, Frazier I, Lussier D, Feifel D, Fischer H, Ebner NC. Neuroplasticity after acute and repeated exposure to oxytocin: a multi-site MRI analysis. Organization for Human Brain Mapping, Suntec, SG, June 2018.

Salmeron D*, Somerville J*, **Horta M**, Plasencia GM, Weir D, Hofmann B*, Feifel D*, Cruz-Almeida Y, Ebner NC. Safety of chronic intranasal oxytocin administration and functional benefits in aging. Cognitive Aging Conference, Atlanta, GA, May 2018.

Salmeron D*, Somerville J*, **Horta M**, Plasencia GM, Weir D*, Hofmann B*, Feifel D, Cruz-Almeida Y, Ebner NC. Safety of chronic intranasal oxytocin administration and functional benefits in aging. Poster on the Hill Conference, Washington, DC, April 2018.

Salmeron D*, Somerville J*, **Horta M**, Plasencia GM, Weir D*, Hofmann B*, Anton SD, Cohen RA, Fischer H, Feifel D, Cruz-Almeida Y, Ebner NC. Safety of acute intranasal oxytocin administration in healthy adults. Spring Undergraduate Research Symposium, University of Florida, Gainesville, FL, March 2018.

Salmeron D*, Somerville J*, **Horta M**, Plasencia GM, Weir D*, Hofmann B*, Feifel D, Cruz-Almeida Y, Ebner NC. Safety of acute intranasal oxytocin administration in healthy adults. Florida Undergraduate Research Conference, Melbourne, FL, February 2018.

Salmeron D*, **Horta M**, Somerville J*, Plasencia GM, Weir D*, Hofmann B*, Anton SD, Cohen RA, Fischer H, Feifel D, Ebner NC. Safety of acute intranasal oxytocin administration in healthy older adults. Undergraduate Research Day, University of Florida, Gainesville, FL, October 2017.

Conner L, Dalton I, **Horta M**, Gulliford D, Frazier I, Ebner NC, Lighthall N. Information integration in economic value judgments: Shift from affective to deliberative decision network regions. Society for Social and Affective Neuroscience Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA, March 2017.

Ebner NC, Lin T, **Horta M**, Woods A, Cohen RA, Feifel D, Fischer H. Intranasal oxytocin affects perceptions of facial trustworthiness in young and older adults. Society for Social and Affective Neuroscience Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA, March 2017.

Horta M, Lin T, Ziaei M, Soliman A*, Porges EC, Feifel D, Oliveira D, Fischer H, Cohen RA, Ebner NC. Effects of single-dose intranasal oxytocin on dynamic facial emotion identification among young and older adults. Society for Social and Affective Neuroscience Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA, March 2017.

Lin T, **Horta M**, Fischer H, Feifel D, Cohen RA, Ebner NC. Effects of intranasal oxytocin on perceptions of trustworthiness in aging. Gerontological Society of America Annual Meeting, New Orleans, LA, November 2016.

Ebner NC, Chen H, Porges EC, Lin T, **Horta M**, Fischer H, Feifel D, Cohen RA. Oxytocin's effect on resting-state functional connectivity varies by age and sex. Society for Social and Affective Neuroscience Annual Meeting, New York, NY, April 2016.

Ebner NC, Chen H, Porges EC, Lin T, **Horta M**, Fischer H, Feifel D, Cohen RA. Oxytocin's effect on resting-state functional connectivity varies by age and sex. Cognitive Aging Conference, Atlanta, GA, April 2016.

Horta M, Lin T, Garcia A, Ebner NC. Functional connectivity during dynamic emotion identification: Effects of age and oxytocin. Society for Social and Affective Neuroscience Annual Meeting, New York, NY, April 2016.

Horta M, Lin T, Gulliford D, Cohen RA, Ebner NC. Dynamic emotion identification: Effects of age and oxytocin. The Gerontological Society of America Annual Meeting, Orlando, FL, November 2015.

Horta M, Lin T, Fischer H, Cohen RA, Feifel D, Ebner NC. Does oxytocin affect meta-mood and prosocial decision-making in aging? University of Florida Annual Spotlight on Aging Research, Gainesville, FL, September 2015.

Balasubramaniyan A, Clark M, **Horta M**, Uyar F, Karim H, Erickson K. Examining sex differences in a visual food cue task. Multimodal Neuroimaging Training Program Summer Workshop Symposium on Health Neuroscience, Pittsburgh, PA, July 2015.

Horta M, Lin T, Fischer H, Cohen RA, Feifel D, Ebner NC. Does oxytocin affect emotional competence and prosocial decision-making in aging? Association for Psychological Science Annual Convention, New York, NY, May 2015.

Horta M, Lin T, Fischer H, Cohen RA, Feifel D, Ebner NC. Does oxytocin affect emotional competence and prosocial decision-making in aging? Annual Institute for Learning in Retirement Student Research on Aging Exposition and Awards, Gainesville, FL, March 2015.

Horta M, Lin T, Fischer H, Cohen RA, Feifel D, Ebner NC. Does oxytocin affect emotional competence and prosocial decision-making in aging? Scientific Research Network on Decision Neuroscience and Aging Conference, Miami, FL, March 2015.

Lin T, **Horta M**, Fischer H, Cohen RA, Feifel D, Ebner NC. Effects of intranasal oxytocin on perceptions of facial trustworthiness vary by age and gender. Scientific Research Network on Decision Neuroscience and Aging Conference, Miami, FL, March 2015.

Horta M, Rilling JK. Longitudinal effects of PURPLE intervention on paternal neural responses to infant cries. Society for Psychophysiological Research 54th Annual Meeting, Atlanta, GA, September 2014.

Horta M, Rilling JK. Longitudinal effects of PURPLE intervention on paternal neural responses to infant cries. Emory University Laney Graduate School STEM Research and Career Symposium, Atlanta, GA, March 2014.

Skill-Building Workshops and Summer Schools

Competitive

2025	Scientific Research Network on Decision Neuroscience and Aging Daily Life Sampling Workshop, Boston, MA
2025	Center for Advancement and Dissemination of Intervention Optimization: Introduction to the Multiphase Optimization Strategy (MOST) Virtual Workshop
2023	Summer School on Modeling Heterogeneity: Advances in Behavioral Decision Analytics, Innsbruck, AT
2023	National Institute of Drug Abuse Diversity Scholars Network Mock Grant Review, Bethesda, MD
2021	Enhanced Interdisciplinary Research Training Institute on Hispanic Substance Abuse, University of Southern California, Pasadena, CA
2020 – 2021	Adolescent Brain Cognitive Development (ABCD) ReproNim Reproducible Data Analyses Virtual Course
2020 – 2021	Neurohackademy Online
2019	Kavli Summer Institute in Cognitive Neuroscience, Santa Barbara, CA
2017	Summer School in Social Neuroscience and Neuroeconomics, Duke University, Durham, NC
2017	RAND Summer Institute for Aging Research, Santa Monica, CA
2015	Multimodal Neuroimaging Training Program Summer Workshop and Symposium on Health Neuroscience, University of Pittsburgh and Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA
2012	Center for Neuroscience Summer Undergraduate Research Program, University of Pittsburgh, Pittsburgh, PA

Non-competitive/Invited

2024	Mindful Living: Teachings and Practices from Mindfulness-Based Stress Reduction, Drala Mountain Center, Red Feather Lakes, CO
2024	Mindfulness-Based Stress Reduction Live Virtual Course, Stress Reduction Clinic at UMass Medical Center
2022	Methods in Neuroscience at Dartmouth fMRI Image Acquisition and Analyses with SPM and ICA Virtual Course
2021	Creating Experiments in PsychoPy Virtual Workshop
2020	Postdoc Writing Program, University of Florida, Gainesville, FL
2019	Scientific Research Network on Decision Neuroscience and Aging Data Harmonization Workshop, Miami, FL
2018	Resting-State and Brain Connectivity Educational Workshop, Montreal Neurological Institute, Montreal, QC, CA
2018	Event-related Potential (ERP) Mini Bootcamp, University of Florida, Gainesville, FL
2017	Transcranial direct current stimulation (tDCS) Workshop, University of Florida, Gainesville, FL
2017	Scientific Research Network on Decision Neuroscience and Aging Tools of the Trade Workshop: Human Neuroimaging Methods and Best Practices, Los Angeles, CA

Methodological Background and Experience

- Statistical Training and Coursework
 - Computational Modeling Workshop, University of Florida, 2024
 - Modeling the Mind Virtual Course, University of Arizona, 2022
 - Pittsburgh Summer Methodology Series: Designing Ambulatory Assessment Studies and Multilevel Modeling for Longitudinal Data Virtual Workshop, 2021
 - Bayesian Statistics Workshop, University of Florida, Gainesville, FL, 2020
 - CLP6529C: Applied Multivariate Statistics, University of Florida, Gainesville, FL, 2015
 - CLP6528C: Measurements, Research Design, and Statistics 2, University of Florida, Gainesville, FL, 2014
 - CLP6527C: Measurements, Research Design, and Statistics, University of Florida, Gainesville, FL, 2014
 - The Odum Institute for Research in Social Science Summer Workshop, University of North Carolina, Chapel Hill, NC, 2014
- Neuroimaging (fMRI, DWI), EEG/ERP, tDCS, and eye-tracking data collection
- Philips Achieva 3T MRI Operator
- Pharmacological and behavioral intervention administration
- Non-human primate and human research
- Research regulation (IRB, Clinical Trials)
- Coding experience (Matlab, Unix, R)
- Software experience:
 - Neuroimaging data analysis (Brain Voyager, FSL, SPM, CONN, PLSC)
 - Neuroimaging data visualization (Caret, MANGO, MRIcron)
 - EEG/ERP analysis (EEGlab/ERPLab)
 - Statistical analysis (SPSS, SAS, Stata, G*Power, NeuroPower)
 - Motion tracking (MaxTRAQ, MaxMATE)
 - Audio editing and analysis (Audacity, PRAAT)
 - Experimental design (E-Prime, PsychoPy3)
 - mHealth workflow development and design (Figma)

Teaching Experience

Spring 2022	Role: Guest Speaker Course: University of Florida Pain and Aging Journal Club Lecture: "Social-decision-making in chronic pain"
Spring 2022	Role: Guest Lecturer Course: Research Colloquium in Developmental Psychology (DEP6059) Lecture: "Neuropeptide administration and measurement in aging"
Fall 2021	Role: Guest Lecturer Course: University of Florida Department of Psychology MRI Interest Group Lecture: "Network Parcellation Selection and their Effects on Developmental Samples and Individual Differences: Review of Bryce et al., 2021"
Fall 2021	Role: Guest Lecturer Course: Research Colloquium in Behavioral and Cognitive Neuroscience (PSY6930) Lecture: Early Research Career Interview with Graduate Students Instructor: Lori Knackstedt, PhD

- Spring 2021** **Role:** Guest Lecturer
Course: University of Florida Department of Psychology MRI Interest Group
Lecture: "Overview of the CONN Functional Connectivity Toolbox"
- Fall 2020** **Role:** Guest Lecturer
Course: Research Colloquium in Developmental Psychology (DEP6059)
Lecture: "PRISMA and CONSORT Guidelines, Open Science Framework, and Professional Development"
Instructor: Natalie Ebner, PhD
- Spring 2020** **Role:** Guest Lecturer
Course: University of Florida Department of Psychology MRI Interest Group
Lecture: "Overview of Partial Least Squares Analysis for Neuroimaging Data"
- Spring 2019** **Role:** Graduate Course Instructor
Course: General Psychology (PSY2012)
- Spring 2016** **Role:** Graduate Teaching Assistant
Course: General Psychology (PSY2012)
Instructor: Nicole Dorey, PhD
- Fall 2015** **Role:** Graduate Teaching Assistant and Guest Lecturer
Course: Lifespan Developmental Psychology (DEP3053)
Lecture: "Socioemotional Development in Early Adulthood"
Instructor: Natalie Ebner, PhD
- 2014 – 2017** **Role:** Graduate Teaching Assistant
Course: Developmental Psychology (DEP3053)
Instructor: Marina Klimenko, PhD

Mentorship Experience

Mentee: Brooke Bethune, Undergraduate, University of South Florida
Program: Moffitt Cancer Center Students Pursuing Undergraduate Research Program
Project: Extending the reach: A narrative review on mindfulness-based interventions for African American caregivers and future applications in behavioral oncology
Role: Mentored on narrative review and data analysis

Mentee: Jorge Romero, Undergraduate, University of South Florida
Program: University of South Florida Undergraduate Honors Thesis
Project: Use of an Augmented Reality App for Smoking Cessation: An Undergraduate Student's Contributions
Role: Co-advisor on thesis committee

Mentee: Julia Cochran, Undergraduate, University of Florida
Program: NIH PA-21-071 Diversity Supplement
Project: Mechanisms of Oxytocin's Analgesia in Older Adults (NIA 3R01AG059809-04S1)
Role: Mentored on experimental methodology and career development

Mentee: Amber Heemskerk, Post-Baccalaureate, University of Florida
Program: NIH PA-20-222 Diversity Supplement
Project: Uncovering and Surveilling Financial Deception Risk in Aging (NIA 3R01AG057764-03S1)
Role: Mentored on experimental methodology, paper writing, and career development

Mentee: Dinia Salmeron, Undergraduate, University of Florida

Program: University Scholars

Project: Safety of chronic intranasal oxytocin administration in aging

Role: Mentored on experimental methodology, statistical analysis, paper writing, and career development

Mentee: Jessie Somerville, Undergraduate, University of Florida

Program: National Science Foundation Research Experiences for Undergraduates

Project: Safety of single-dose intranasal oxytocin administration in aging

Role: Mentored on experimental methodology, statistical analysis, paper writing, and career development

Mentee: Katie Buzzanca, Undergraduate, University of Florida

Program: National Science Foundation Research Experiences for Undergraduates

Project: Differences in response inhibition during an emotional go/no-go task among healthy young and older adults (Senior Thesis)

Role: Mentored on experimental methodology, statistical analysis, paper writing, preparation for senior thesis defense, and career development

Service

Journal Reviews

2023	<i>Journal of Psychiatry and Brain Science</i>
2023	<i>Data in Brief</i>
2023	<i>Scientific Data</i>
2023	<i>Journal of Gerontology: Psychological Sciences</i>
2021	<i>Social Cognitive and Affective Neuroscience</i>
2020 - 2024	<i>Psychoneuroendocrinology</i>
2020	<i>Translational Psychiatry</i>
2017	<i>Psychology and Aging</i>
2014	<i>Cognition and Emotion</i>

Volunteer and Organizational Work

2024 -	Role: Expert Steering Committee Member Program: Active Monitoring of Oxytocin Research Evidence (AMORE) Platform
2022 – 2023	Role: Workshops Committee Member Program: Early Career Leadership Committee of the National Hispanic Science Network
2021 – 2023	Role: Reviewer Program: Leighton E. Cluff Graduate Student Award for Aging Research
2020	Role: Member Program: Research Scientist Search Committee for the Department of Psychology at the University of Florida
2019	Role: Volunteer Program: Brain Awareness Week, North Central Florida Chapter of the Society for Neuroscience
2019	Role: Lead Graduate Organizer Program: 9 th Annual Institute for Learning in Retirement Student Research on Aging Poster Competition and the Robert Levitt Awards at Oak Hammock
2018	Role: Lead Graduate Organizer Program: Dr. Jacquelin Goldman Speaker Series: Dr. Mara Mather
2018	Role: Graduate Co-organizer Program: 8 th Annual Institute for Learning in Retirement Student Research on Aging Exposition and the Robert Levitt Awards at Oak Hammock

- 2014 – 2020** **Role:** Member
Program: Diversity Affirmation and Awareness Committee at the University of Florida
- 2012 – 2013** **Role:** Editor
Program: Florida State University Council for Undergraduate Research and Creativity

Professional Affiliations

- American Psychological Association Division 20 (Adult Development and Aging)
- American Psychological Association Division 50 (Society of Addiction Psychology)
- Gerontological Society for America
- National Hispanic Science Network on Drug Abuse
- Scientific Research Network on Decision Neuroscience and Aging
- Social and Affective Neuroscience Society
- Society for Research on Nicotine and Tobacco
- United States Association for the Study of Pain

Media Appearances

- Audio
 - **Horta M.** (2025, March 3). Dr. Marilyn Horta [Audio podcast episode]. In Decision and aging insights: an SRNDNA Podcast. Scientific Research Network on Decision Neuroscience and Aging. [Listen here.](#)
 - **Horta M.** (2023, July 7). Deception risk [Audio podcast episode]. In the In Your Brain Podcast. [Listen here.](#)
 - **Horta M.** (2021, October 22). Episode 13 [Audio podcast episode]. In the University of Florida Center for Addiction Research and Education Podcast. University of Florida. [Listen here.](#)
- Print
 - Anderson LA. (2024, May 28). Gainesville law enforcement, researchers weigh the impact of rising online scams. The Independent Florida Alligator [Internet]. [Read here.](#)
 - Hamilton E. (2024, February 12). Older adults rely more on trust in decision making. It could open them up to scams. University of Florida News [Internet]. [Read here.](#)
 - Perez E, Shoenfelt A, **Horta M**, Ebner NC, Lighthall NR. (2024, January 22). Facing wolves in sheep's clothing: How younger and older adults differ in trust-related decision-making and learning. *Behind the Paper by Springer Nature*. [Read here.](#)